

Rumours are on about imminent price cuts to Intel CPUs

Corsair, a brand known for its memory products has now entered the PC chassis market

Nokia 5800 XpressMusic

Touch me not

The Nokia 5800 XpressMusic is the latest addition to the range of Nokia XpressMusic phones; this time it is a full touch screen phone.

The phone that we received was the red model, and this is not a light red but a very dark red with a thin outline of translucent red towards the back of the phone. The back cover of the phone is a mix of brown and red and sports a design of lines which first started with the Nokia N82/N78 phones.

There are three thin buttons on the front of the phone which are highlighted when on – green (Call Accept), white (Main Menu) and red (Call Reject). You need to put in some effort when using these buttons as they are slightly hard to push and quite thin. On one side of the phone you have the volume controls and the camera button as well as the screen lock slider; these button sizes are pretty decent and easy to use. This phone does not have the traditional key press combination of locking the screen, but instead you can just slide the small button on the side to either lock or unlock the screen. The other side of the phone has slots for the microSD and your SIM card. These slots actually look like buttons but can be lifted up to reveal the slots. Inserting the SIM card in is easy but to remove it you need to open the back cover, remove the battery and then use something to push the card out. This is only for the SIM card and not the memory card. The stylus for this phone is attached on the back cover. The loudspeaker is present towards the side of the phone.

Nokia has gone the resistive touch way which means that you cannot use the pads of your fingers but instead you have to use your fingertips to touch, and you also have to touch harder. Due to the resistive touch you could say that this phone is more in favour of the stylus rather than the free touch of the Apple iPhone/iPod Touch. The accelerometer of this phone is slow, so when you change the orientation the screen blacks out before coming back on again to give you the horizontal view. Also it rotates to the left and not all around. The touch games that come preloaded with the phone were not really fun. In one of the games, Touch Bounce, you have to run your finger on the screen to move forward and at times you actually tend to block the screen itself due to this. There is no N-Gage platform for the phone which would have been a great thing to have.

You will find the classic Nokia menus present on this phone, with a familiar layout and options; an additional menu is the XpressMusic touch button located above the display which acts as a quick launch menu for the multimedia options – Music, Gallery, Sharing, Video Center

(sic) and Web. This phone comes with only one preloaded theme, but this can be customized further and you can select from whichever buttons or contacts that you want to be displayed on the home screen to having a different wallpaper on that theme.

The camera is a 3.2 MP with a Carl Zeiss lens and a dual LED flash light. The camera has a good auto focus feature but takes only average quality photos.

There are a variety of choices when it comes to writing an SMS on this phone. You can choose from either the classic alphanumeric keypad, Mini QWERTY keypad, Full screen QWERTY or the new introduction from Nokia – handwriting, where you can use the stylus to write the message directly instead using button input. But this will not work out for everybody as the device only recognizes block capitals and not a cursive style of writing. However, a feature has been added where you can be trained to write for this phone. So, you

basically have to change your entire writing style to use this feature. There are also quick action buttons when you receive a message such as delete, forward and reply, so you don't have to open an extra menu to select from these.

Playing music on this touch screen, Symbian OS phone is quite a challenge. Scrolling through the list of songs is not accurate. You scroll too fast and you easily skip beyond where you want to stop. And to top it all, it doesn't even scroll smoothly, which is either an OS booboo or the phone's hardware is simply too slow. There is also a feature for creating a playlist on the phone itself, but we didn't enjoy doing this as if you create multiple playlists you have to go through a couple of menus to correctly select the playlist and browsing through the list of songs is not that impressive, as was mentioned earlier.

The call quality on the phone is good; we did not experience any disturbance or echoing during the call. But the speaker quality on the other hand is not that impressive even though it is loud. You can't really enjoy the music but for a quick share the loud speaker would be fine. There is a 3.5 mm headphone jack provided but surprisingly sound quality is not as good as expected, and definitely not good enough for a music phone.

This phone is definitely feature rich, but that's what you would expect from a phone based on the Symbian platform. Even so, this phone is still lacking the actual touch screen experience and paying Rs. 21,839 for a device that has a glaring flaw in the touch department is really not on. A keypad would give better value, but not remove the underlying shortcomings. As it is, the large screen is an attraction and it's a decent looking, feature-rich device – watch out for price drops in the next six months.

Specifications:

Dimensions: 111 x 51.7 x 15.5 mm, Weight: 109 g, Resolution: 640 x 360 pixels (nHD), aspect ratio 16:9, Micro-USB connector, 81 MB internal memory, 8GB microSD memory card in-box, expandable up to 16GB

Ratings

Features: 7
Performance: 6
Build quality: 7.5
Value for money: 5.5
Overall: 6.5

Contact: Nokia India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-11-3030 3838
Email: communications.india@nokia.com
Web site: www.nokia.com
Price: Rs. 21,839

